

# FILM DOSSIER: CAPTAIN AMERICA

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Phase 1 · Film #6

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

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## 1. IDENTITY

| Field                  | Entry                                                                           |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Film #                 | 6 of 29                                                                         |
| Phase                  | Phase 1                                                                         |
| Real title             | <i>CAPTAIN AMERICA</i>                                                          |
| Decoy / codename title | <i>"VICTORY GARDEN"</i>                                                         |
| Release date           | Friday, July 22, 2011                                                           |
| Distributor            | Paramount Pictures                                                              |
| Director               | Joe Johnston                                                                    |
| Rating / runtime       | PG-13 · 156 minutes                                                             |
| Genre + second genre   | Superhero action-adventure + <b>WWII war epic</b> (the MCU's only period piece) |

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## 2. OWNERSHIP

| Field                           | Entry                                                      |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Whose film / franchise is this? | <b>TYRESE AVERY.</b> The Captain America franchise is his. |

| Character                                                  | Actor                                                                  | Age at release                                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Steve Rogers / Captain America                             | Tyrese Avery                                                           | 29 ( <i>plays 20 → 24; black don't crack</i> ) |
| James "Bucky" Barnes                                       | Sebastian Stan                                                         | 28                                             |
| Johann Schmidt / The Red Skull                             | Hugo Weaving                                                           | 51                                             |
| Dr. Abraham Erskine                                        | Stanley Tucci                                                          | 50                                             |
| Peggy Carter                                               | Hayley Atwell                                                          | 29                                             |
| Gen. Chester Phillips                                      | Tommy Lee Jones                                                        | 64                                             |
| Sgt. Nick Fury                                             | Samuel L. Jackson ( <i>digitally de-aged for WWII</i> )                | 62                                             |
| Cpl. Timothy "Dum Dum" Dugan                               | Neal McDonough                                                         | 45                                             |
| Pvt. Gabe Jones                                            | Derek Luke                                                             | 37                                             |
| Baron Heinrich Zemo                                        | Christoph Waltz ( <i>fresh casting: never played by a real actor</i> ) | 54                                             |
| Namor the Sub-Mariner ( <i>Invaders cameo</i> )            | Tenoch Huerta                                                          | 30                                             |
| Mistress Death ( <i>uncredited; on the ice floe</i> )      | Aubrey Plaza                                                           | 27                                             |
| Stan Lee ( <i>cameo: a general at the medal ceremony</i> ) | Stan Lee                                                               | 88                                             |

*Accuracy flag: on 616, Bucky is a teenager in 1941. Sebastian Stan (28) is the only real actor to have played him, so per the Casting Rules he keeps the role. Bucky is written as the oldest-looking 17-year-old in the Army, which is also how Ed Brubaker's modern 616 version frames him.*

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### 3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

| Field                    | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary comic(s) adapted | <i>Captain America Comics</i> #1 (March 1941), Joe Simon & Jack Kirby: Project: Rebirth, Dr. Erskine's assassination, Bucky, the Red Skull. <i>The Avengers</i> #4 (March 1964), Lee & Kirby: <b>Zemo's drone plane</b> , Bucky's "death," and Cap frozen in the ice.                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Supporting comics        | <i>Captain America Comics</i> #2 (1941, the <b>round shield</b> ) · <i>Captain America</i> #303 (1985, <b>Dr. Myron MacLain</b> and the shield's accidental alloy) · <i>Sgt. Fury and His Howling Commandos</i> #13 (1964): Cap and Bucky fight beside <b>Fury's Howlers</b> · <i>The Avengers</i> #6 (1964, Zemo's <b>Adhesive X</b> ) · <i>The Invaders</i> (1975, Roy Thomas): Namor and the original Human Torch · Ed Brubaker's <i>Captain America</i> (2005 on): the modern version of Bucky |
| Nerf check               | ✓ Cap is <b>the peak of human potential</b> , the best hand-to-hand fighter and battlefield tactician alive. His shield is <b>indestructible</b> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

#### 3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                               |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Overall accuracy score | <b>97%</b> . The Golden Age origin is almost exact, joined to the <i>Avengers</i> #4 flashback of how Cap was lost. |

##### Straight from the page:

- **Frail Steve Rogers** is rejected by the Army. **Dr. Abraham Erskine** chooses him for **Project: Rebirth**. He's given the **super-soldier serum** and bathed in **Vita-Rays**, and he becomes the **perfect human**.
- A **Nazi spy (Heinz Kruger)** assassinates Erskine straight afterward, and the formula dies with him. **Steve is the only one**.
- **At Camp Lehigh, Virginia**, Steve poses as a **clumsy private**. The camp mascot, **Bucky Barnes**, walks in on him changing into costume and becomes his partner.
- **The first shield is the triangular one** (*CA Comics* #1), and it's later replaced by **the round shield**, a gift from **President Roosevelt** (*CA Comics* #2), made from an alloy **Dr. Myron MacLain** created by accident and could never reproduce.
- **The Red Skull**, Johann Schmidt, is Hitler's right hand. **In WWII he wears a red skull MASK** (Golden Age), so this Skull is a man in a mask. He uses the **Dust of Death**.
- **Cap and Bucky fight beside Sgt. Nick Fury's Howling Commandos** (*Sgt. Fury* #13).
- **The Invaders**: Namor and the android Human Torch appear in a battle montage.
- **April 1945**: Cap and Bucky try to stop **Baron Zemo's** explosive-rigged **drone plane**. Bucky is still on it when it blows up. **Cap falls into the icy North Atlantic** and freezes in suspended animation (*Avengers* #4).

##### Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| The Red Skull and Zemo both appear in one film | Runtime. They're Cap's two great WWII enemies, and both

come straight from the comics. |

| The Invaders are a montage cameo | They're held for a future WWII-era project. Their existence is set up. |

| Steve's age: b. **July 4, 1920** (616) | 616 accurate. Tyrese plays 20–24. |

## POWERS & ABILITIES

| Character              | 616 powers & abilities                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Shown in this film                                                                                                                                                                                    | Held back (why)                                                         | Match                                  |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| <b>Captain America</b> | The super-soldier serum: <b>peak-human strength</b> (lifts more than 1,000 lbs overhead), <b>speed, agility, endurance, reflexes and healing</b> at the very limit of human potential; he doesn't tire the way ordinary men do; <b>master martial artist; tactical genius; master of the shield</b> (ricochet throws) ( <i>CA Comics</i> #1 on) | All of it: outruns a car, throws the shield in a triple ricochet that takes out three machine-gun nests, carries a wounded Howler five miles through snow, fights twelve Nazi soldiers in a train car | –                                                                       | ✓ 100%                                 |
| <b>The shield</b>      | <b>Indestructible</b> round shield of an accidental alloy; perfectly balanced for ricochet throws; absorbs impacts                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Stops a tank round point-blank; ricochet throws                                                                                                                                                       | –                                                                       | ✓ 100%                                 |
| <b>Bucky Barnes</b>    | Expert marksman; trained hand-to-hand fighter; commando                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Sniper cover; knife fights                                                                                                                                                                            | His future as the <b>Winter Soldier</b> (616, 2005). Seeded, not shown. | ✓ 100%                                 |
| <b>The Red Skull</b>   | <b>No superpowers in WWII</b> (616); <b>master strategist</b> , expert fighter; the <b>Dust of Death</b> (a toxin that shrivels its victims' heads into red skulls)                                                                                                                                                                             | The Dust of Death kills a traitor, and he holds his own with Cap in hand-to-hand for a round                                                                                                          | His later cloned body with serum (616, later)                           | ✓ 100% (the Golden Age Skull is human) |
| <b>Baron Zemo</b>      | Genius scientist; expert swordsman; <b>Adhesive X</b> ; death-ray weapons ( <i>Avengers</i> #4, #6)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Adhesive X (and the hood glued to his face), the drone plane, a sword duel with Cap                                                                                                                   | –                                                                       | ✓ 100%                                 |
| <b>Nick Fury</b>       | Master soldier, tactician and leader; the <b>Infinity Formula</b> (injected after the war on 616, so not shown here)                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Leads the Howling Commandos                                                                                                                                                                           | The Infinity Formula (backstory for later)                              | ✓ 100%                                 |
| <b>Namor</b>           | Mutant Atlantean prince: <b>superhuman strength, flight</b> (ankle wings), amphibious                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Leaps out of the sea and tears apart a U-boat                                                                                                                                                         | His full story (Phase 2)                                                | ✓ 100%                                 |

## 4. STORY

| Field                | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Logline              | A frail young man from the Lower East Side becomes the only super-soldier in history. He leads America's fight against the Red Skull and gives everything, including the next sixty-seven years, to win the war. |
| Theme                | <b>Courage belongs to the heart, not the body.</b> Steve was a hero before the serum. The serum just caught up.                                                                                                  |
| Villain / antagonist | <b>The Red Skull</b> (main); <b>Baron Heinrich Zemo</b> (the finale)                                                                                                                                             |

### What the movie is about

#### ACT ONE: REBIRTH

- **New York, Monday, December 9, 1940.** **Steve Rogers**, 20, skinny and sick, is rejected for the fourth time. He doesn't give up.
- **Dr. Abraham Erskine** watches him throw himself on a dummy grenade in a training yard and chooses him.
- **Tuesday, March 4, 1941, Project: Rebirth.** The serum and the Vita-Rays turn Steve into **the perfect human**.
- Seconds later a Nazi spy **shoots Erskine dead**. Steve runs him down on foot, but the formula is gone. **There will only be one.**

#### ACT TWO: THE SENTINEL OF LIBERTY

- Steve is secretly stationed at **Camp Lehigh, Virginia**, posing as a clumsy private. The camp mascot, **Bucky Barnes**, catches him changing into his costume, and they become partners.
- The **triangular shield**, and then the **round one**, which **President Roosevelt** gives him in the Oval Office.
- **Pearl Harbor**. Cap and Bucky go to war.
- They team up with **Sgt. Nick Fury's Howling Commandos**, who include Dugan, Gabe Jones and the rest of the 616 Howlers, and they run operations across occupied Europe with **Peggy Carter** of the French Resistance.
- The **Invaders** battle montage: Namor bursts out of the Channel, and a flaming android flies overhead.
- **The Red Skull**. Hitler's terror operative, masked, uses the Dust of Death on his own officers and plans the ruin of the Allies.

#### ACT THREE: THE ICE

- **Normandy, June 6, 1944** (Fury's line from Chapter One). Cap duels the Red Skull in a collapsing bunker. The Skull is caught by his own Dust of Death and **disappears**.
- **Baron Zemo** builds a **drone plane loaded with explosives** aimed at London.
- **Wednesday, April 25, 1945, over the North Atlantic.** Cap and Bucky catch the drone at takeoff. Cap is thrown clear. **Bucky stays on board, trying to disarm it**, and the plane **explodes**.
- Cap falls into the black water and the ice closes over him.
- The last image is **the shield sinking into the dark**.

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## 5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

| Field                   | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When it's set           | <b>Monday, December 9, 1940</b> → <b>Wednesday, April 25, 1945</b> . Both post-credit scenes take place in <b>2011</b> (see below).                                                                                                                                           |
| Where it's set          | <b>New York</b> (the Lower East Side, Brooklyn) · <b>Camp Lehigh, Virginia</b> · <b>Washington, D.C.</b> (the Oval Office) · <b>Occupied France and Germany</b> · <b>Normandy</b> · <b>the North Atlantic</b> (filmed on location in England, the Czech Republic and Iceland) |
| Relative to other films | <b>The earliest events in the MCU</b> . In the present day, the post-credit scenes are set in <b>mid-2011</b> (around June), <b>fourteen months after <i>Iron Man 2</i></b> .                                                                                                 |

### Steve Rogers timeline (canon):

| Event | Date |  
|---|---|  
| Born, Lower East Side | July 4, 1920 |  
| Project: Rebirth | March 4, 1941 |  
| Frozen | April 25, 1945 (age 24) |  
| Found | *The Avengers* (2012) |

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## 6. WORLD-BUILDING

### The film's own world

- **WWII in the MCU**: Project: Rebirth, **the only super-soldier**, the Howling Commandos, the Invaders.
- **The shield**, and the alloy nobody can reproduce.
- **The Red Skull** and **Zemo**, Cap's permanent enemies.
- **Peggy Carter** and **Bucky**, the two people Steve loses.

## World-building for the wider MCU

| Seed                        | How it appears                                                                                  | Payoff                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Nick Fury's history         | Sgt. Fury and the Howlers on screen. This is where Samuel L. Jackson's Fury <b>comes from</b> . | Every later film                                                                           |
| Why Fury has been searching | Fury saw Cap fall                                                                               | The <i>Iron Man 2</i> post-credit scene, and <i>The Avengers</i>                           |
| The Invaders: Namor         | The Channel montage                                                                             | <b><i>The Avengers</i>: Namor is the one who finds Cap in the ice (<i>Avengers</i> #4)</b> |
| The Winter Soldier          | See the Big Bad setup below                                                                     | Phase 2                                                                                    |
| The Red Skull lives         | The mid-credit scene                                                                            | Phase 2                                                                                    |

## Setting up the Big Bad

| Seed             | How it appears                                                                                                                                                                                | What it means                                                                                      |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Death turns away | As the drone plane explodes, only the audience sees <b>the hooded woman</b> standing on the ice floe, looking toward Bucky. <b>Then she turns away</b> , as if there's nothing there for her. | <b>Bucky isn't dead.</b> The Winter Soldier is coming, and Death doesn't take what isn't hers.     |
| The Cosmic Cube  | The post-credit scene                                                                                                                                                                         | The <b>first thing Thanos went after on 616</b> , before the Gems ( <i>Captain Marvel</i> #27–33). |

## 7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mid-credit scene       | <p>✓ "SLEEPER." <b>Present day, 2011.</b> A sealed Nazi bunker in the Bavarian Alps, found by a hiking party. A flashlight moves over a <b>stasis chamber</b> filled with red gas. Inside, <b>a man in a red skull mask</b> is still breathing, very slowly.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Post-credit scene      | <p>✓ "THE CUBE." <b>Present day, 2011.</b> A sterile lab. Scientists in <b>yellow beekeeper-style suits, A.I.M.</b> (Advanced Idea Mechanics), watch <b>a small, glowing cube</b> hover in a containment field. <b>A.I.M. SCIENTIST:</b> "<i>Stable. It's stable. Anything we imagine...</i>"</p> <p>The cube flashes. For a split second, <b>every screen in the lab shows the same image: a golden helmet and a purple face.</b> Then it's gone.</p> <p><b>CUT TO BLACK. "CAPTAIN AMERICA WILL RETURN IN <i>THE AVENGERS</i>."</b></p> |
| Secret shoot codenames | Mid-credit: " <b>FIELD TRIP.</b> " Post-credit: " <b>BEE KEEPING.</b> "                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

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## CHECKLIST

- ☐ Comic(s) adapted · ☐ Comic Accuracy Report + powers · ☐ Real and decoy titles · ☐ What it's about · ☐ Villain · ☐ Post-credit scenes · ☐ The film's own world-building · ☐ MCU world-building · ☐ Big Bad setup · ☐ Whose franchise · ☐ When and where in the timeline